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Re: Submission -Did Debt Restructuring or Copper Drive Zambia's Recovery? A Macro-Fiscal Analysis (2015–2025)

Dear Ms. Chama, Mr. Spratt, and Dr. Shale,

Please find attached my final Executive Report and Power BI dashboard on Zambia's macro-fiscal transition from 2015 to 2025.

The analysis set out to answer a question with significant implications for Zambia's economic outlook: was the post-default recovery driven by the 2023 debt restructuring, or by the copper price supercycle that preceded it? The evidence points to both playing a necessary role - copper created the fiscal breathing room, while the G20 Common Framework deal converted that window into a durable institutional framework, evidenced most clearly by FDI net inflows reaching a decade-high of 9.32% of GDP in 2024.

Beyond the primary diagnosis, the report surfaces three structural vulnerabilities that the recovery has not yet resolved: Zambia's continued exposure to copper price volatility, persistently elevated inflation, and an agricultural sector contributing only 5.54% of GDP despite the country's considerable land endowment. The recommendations focus on industrial value addition, export diversification, and climate-resilient agriculture as fiscal hedges against future commodity shocks.

The dashboard was built in Power BI and draws on data from the World Bank WDI, IMF World Economic Outlook, Bank of Zambia monetary policy statements, and the Ministry of Finance Report on the Economy 2025 for the most current data points.

I would welcome the opportunity to walk through the findings and discuss any questions at your convenience.

Best regards,

Boldwin Mweemba

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